Work Psychology: Job Analysis, Selection, Training, and Evaluation

PSYCHOMETRICIAN · industrial-organizational · BoardPrep lesson v1

Official examination scope

Original psychometrician review of work analysis, job-relevant selection, training transfer, performance evidence, and fair organizational decisions. Scope is limited to the linked official board outline and curriculum references; this is not an exam prediction.

Learning objectives

- Connect a personnel decision to a documented job requirement.
- Interpret selection and performance evidence with validity and fairness limits.
- Evaluate training and organizational interventions using suitable outcomes.

1. Start with the work

Job analysis describes important tasks and the knowledge, skills, abilities, and other characteristics needed to perform them. Gather evidence from relevant work sources and verify that the resulting requirements match the actual role. A selection method should assess job-relevant requirements, be administered consistently, and have evidence appropriate to its intended use. A prestigious or familiar test is not automatically valid for every job.

- Identify critical tasks and performance conditions.
- Link each assessment measure to a requirement.
- Review accessibility and fairness in administration.

2. Selection and measurement

A selection score is one source of evidence, not a guarantee of future performance. Interpret it with reliability, validity, criterion relevance, group impact, and decision consequences in view. Use established procedures, secure test materials, explain appropriate limits, and avoid changing cut scores after seeing candidates unless the method is authorized and justified. Decisions should be reproducible and documented.

- Check what the score predicts and for whom.
- Use consistent conditions and scoring rules.
- Document the evidence and decision rule.

3. Training and transfer

Training evaluation begins with a defined need and learning objective. Learning evidence can show whether knowledge or skill changed; transfer evidence asks whether it is used on the job; organizational outcomes require additional causal caution. Practice, feedback, supervisor support, resources, and opportunity to perform can affect transfer. A satisfaction survey alone does not show competence or business impact.

- Match practice to job tasks.
- Measure learning and transfer separately.
- Consider work conditions that enable or block application.

4. Performance and organizational evidence

Performance criteria should reflect role expectations and use evidence gathered in a fair, consistent way. Avoid halo judgments, recency, and unclear standards by collecting relevant observations over time and explaining criteria. Organizational intervention studies need suitable comparisons and attention to concurrent changes. Keep personnel data confidential, limit access, and communicate conclusions at the level the evidence supports.

- Define criteria before evaluating outcomes.

- Use more than one relevant observation when appropriate.
- Separate association from causal attribution.

Interpret a training result

Question: After a safety course, test scores improve but incident rates are unchanged for one month. What can the evaluation team conclude?
1. Report evidence of higher test performance under the measure used.
2. Do not infer that behavior or incidents changed from that measure alone.
3. Check transfer opportunities, supervision, exposure, and a suitable observation period.
Answer: Knowledge evidence improved; the available data do not yet demonstrate reduced incidents.
Check: The conclusion matches the outcome measured and its time window.

Common misconceptions

- A reliable test is necessarily valid for every hiring decision.
- Candidate ranking alone establishes fairness.
- Training satisfaction proves skill transfer.
- A before-and-after change proves an organizational intervention caused it.

Practice patterns

- Link job requirements to assessment methods.
- Interpret test and performance evidence within its limits.
- Plan a training or intervention evaluation with relevant outcomes.

Official scope references

Official scope: Enhanced Tables of Specifications for the Psychologists and Psychometricians Licensure Examinations — Professional Regulation Commission; Professional Regulatory Board of Psychology — https://prc.gov.ph/Pages/PRBv4/Psychology.htm

Instructional references

Instructional reference: Psychology 2e — OpenStax, Rice University — https://openstax.org/details/books/psychology-2e
Instructional reference: Ethical Principles of Psychologists and Code of Conduct — American Psychological Association — https://www.apa.org/ethics/code

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